

Guianan weeper capuchin

Cebus olivaceus

- ↔ 15–18 in (38–46 cm)
- 📍 NE. South America
- ⊗ Locally common

This sociable, intelligent monkey lives in troops of 20 or more in the rainforests of northern South America. It owes its name to the plaintive, weeping calls that the troop uses to stay in contact while moving through the tree canopy in search of food. Males are bigger than females and compete for dominance; typically, only one dominant male in each troop gets the chance to breed.

Black-capped squirrel monkey

Saimiri boliviensis

- ↔ 11–13 in (27–33 cm)
- 📍 W. to C. South America
- ⊗ Locally common

The small, agile squirrel monkey feeds mainly on fruit and small animals such as insects, flushing them out from the foliage with twittering, clicking calls as it moves through the trees in large troops. These can number 50 or more, sometimes up to 200—much bigger than that of any other South American monkey. They also follow other monkey troops to snatch any insects they disturb.

small white face patch with dark crown above



tail longer than head and body



Goeldi's marmoset

Callimico goeldii

- ↔ 8–9 in (22–23 cm)
- 📍 NW. South America
- ⊗ Vulnerable

Goeldi's marmoset is larger than most marmosets and tamarins. Unknown to the scientific community before 1904, this black-furred species lives in scattered groups in dense undergrowth such as creeper-tangled bamboo. It has a mixed diet of small animals, fruit, and tree sap, which it gathers by using its incisor teeth to make gashes in the bark and licking up the sap that flows from the wounds.

Cotton-top tamarin

Saguinus oedipus

- ↔ 8–10 in (20–25 cm)
- 📍 NW. South America
- ⊗ Critically endangered

Found only in a small part of northwest Colombia, the cotton-top tamarin is unmistakable, thanks to the crest of long white hair that flows down its shoulders. It lives in troops of 2 to 15. When there are more than two adults, males or females may have more than one mate. It feeds on small animals and fruit, searching for food by day. It is constantly on the alert, with one member of the group always keeping watch for danger.

Red-bellied titi

Callicebus moloch

- ↔ 8–10 in (20–25 cm)
- 📍 N. South America
- ⊗ Critically endangered

Speckled brown, with mainly orange underparts, this monkey has such a thick, soft coat that its ears are almost hidden by fur. It lives in dense forests near rivers, swamps, and pools, where it feeds on fruit, leaves, seeds, and insect grubs. Males and females form strong pair-bonds, staying close to each other and singing a “duet” before dawn to defend their territory. The newborns are carried by the male.

Lemurine night monkey

Aotus lemurinus

- ↔ 12–17 in (30–43 cm)
- 📍 Central America to NW. South America
- ⊗ Vulnerable

Sometimes called the owl monkey because of its huge, forward-facing brown eyes and hooting calls, this species and its close relatives are the world's only nocturnal monkeys. Most active at twilight and on moonlit nights when food is easier to see, it climbs cautiously through the forest trees looking for fruit and insects.

De Brazza's monkey

Cercopithecus neglectus

- ↔ 50–59 cm (20–23 in)
- 📍 C. to E. Africa
- ⊗ Common

This tropical forest monkey has a black crown, an orange stripe across its forehead, and a luxuriant white beard and moustache. Most of the rest of its body is covered with speckled gray fur. The male is much bigger than the female, and the species usually lives in small groups headed by a dominant male. De Brazza's monkeys communicate using deep, booming calls.



Patas monkey

Erythrocebus patas

- ↔ 23–35 in (60–88 cm)
- 📍 W. to E. Africa
- ⊗ Common

This slender, long-legged monkey can run at speeds of up to 34 mph (55 km/h), making it the fastest primate. It lives on the ground in open areas, where cover is scarce and speed is often the only effective defense. Troops often consist of females, their young, a single breeding male, and extra group males. If threatened, the male often distracts the predator while the rest of the troop escapes.